

The Supplementary Reference

Everything Not Fully Addressed Elsewhere

July 5, 2026

Contents

EXTRA CLEAN AUTO DETAILING

The Supplementary *Reference*

EVERYTHING NOT FULLY ADDRESSED ELSEWHERE · COMPLETE AND ACCESSIBLE

MAINTENANCE PLANS · PRICING REVIEWS · COMPLAINTS · TAXES · COMPETITORS · SEASONS

The reference layer beneath the comprehensive plan

WHAT'S INSIDE

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Section 01

The Maintenance Plan Agreement

How recurring service relationships actually work in practice.

1.1 Why maintenance plans matter

A maintenance plan client is worth significantly more than a one-time client over their lifetime. Predictable revenue. Predictable scheduling. Lower marketing cost per booking. Stronger word-of-mouth. The maintenance plan is the single highest-leverage retention tool you have.

But maintenance plans only work if they're structured properly. Vague verbal agreements create confusion when expectations don't align. A clear written structure prevents that.

1.2 How the plan is structured

THE BASIC OFFER

Recurring Tier 1 Full Clean every 5 weeks. 10% discount off standard pricing. Priority

scheduling. Reminder sent before each due date. Cancellable with notice.

THE PRICING STRUCTURE

VEHICLE TYPE	STANDARD PRICE	MAINTENANCE PRICE	SAVINGS
Sedan / Car	\$8,000	\$7,200	\$800
SUV / Crossover	\$10,000	\$9,000	\$1,000
Pickup / Van	\$12,000	\$10,800	\$1,200

1.3 The maintenance plan agreement document

Use this language as the basis for a one-page agreement clients sign when enrolling:

AGREEMENT TERMS

“Extra Clean Auto Detailing — Maintenance Plan Agreement”

“Client Name: _____ Vehicle: _____ Plate: _____”

“By enrolling in the Maintenance Plan, the Client commits to recurring Tier 1 Full Clean service approximately every 5 weeks at the discounted Maintenance Price for their vehicle category.”

WHAT’S INCLUDED

- Recurring Full Clean service at 10% off standard pricing
- Reminder notification 3 days before each scheduled service
- Priority scheduling on busy days
- Free minor add-ons such as tyre dressing and air freshener with each service
- First-priority booking access during peak demand periods

WHAT’S NOT INCLUDED

- Tier 2 Deep Clean or Tier 3 Showroom Detail services (available at standard rates)
- Add-on services like clay bar, ceramic sealant, or paint correction
- Exterior damage repair, dent removal, or mechanical work
- Coverage for vehicles not specified in the agreement

SCHEDULING AND CANCELLATION

“The Service Provider will reach out approximately 5 weeks after each completed service to schedule the next session. The Client may reschedule individual sessions with at least 24 hours notice. The Client may cancel the maintenance plan entirely at any time with 7 days written notice. No refunds will be issued for sessions already completed.”

PRICING CHANGES

“The Service Provider reserves the right to adjust maintenance plan pricing with 30 days written notice to the Client. The Client retains the right to

discontinue the maintenance plan if pricing changes are unacceptable.”

QUALITY STANDARD

“Each service will be performed to the standard documented in the Tier 1 Full Clean service procedure. Any concerns about service quality should be raised within 24 hours of completion for resolution.”

1.4 The enrollment conversation

After completing a Tier 1 Full Clean, present the maintenance plan offer:

“Most of my clients book this every 5 weeks to keep their car looking right. If you join my maintenance plan, you get 10% off every recurring service and I send you a reminder when you’re due. For your Corolla that’s \$7,200 instead of \$8,000 every time. Want me to put you down for early next month?”

THE RETENTION MATH

A maintenance plan client at \$7,200 every 5 weeks generates approximately \$75,000 JMD annually. A one-time client at \$8,000 generates exactly \$8,000. The maintenance plan client is worth nearly 10x over a year — and they refer more often because the relationship is established.

1.5 Managing the maintenance plan over time

TRACK EVERY PLAN CLIENT SEPARATELY

In your client tracking spreadsheet, flag maintenance plan clients clearly. Note their next due date. Check this weekly to ensure timely reminders go out.

SEND THE REMINDER CONSISTENTLY

3 days before due date, send: ‘Hey [name], you’re due for your maintenance clean this week. Same day and time as usual work for you?’ Personal, brief, low pressure.

HONOR THE PRIORITY COMMITMENT

When you say maintenance plan clients get priority scheduling, mean it. They get first access to your calendar even if it means rearranging others. The trust this builds is what justifies their commitment.

RECOGNIZE MILESTONES

After 6 months on the plan, send a brief thank-you message. After 12 months, consider a small bonus — a free upgrade or extra add-on. Long-term clients deserve recognition that acknowledges their loyalty.

Section 02

The Pricing Review Framework

When and how to adjust pricing over time without damaging client relationships.

2.1 Why pricing reviews matter

Costs change. Skills improve. Markets shift. If you set prices once and never revisit them, you’ll fall progressively behind. Pricing should be reviewed every 6 months minimum and adjusted based on actual data.

Most detailers under-price for years simply because they never schedule the review. The discipline of scheduled reviews protects against this.

2.2 When to review pricing

SCHEDULED REVIEWS

- Every 6 months — formal review against the framework below
- Annually — comprehensive strategy review including pricing
- After significant cost changes — chemical price increases, fuel changes
- After significant skill or equipment upgrades that justify higher rates

TRIGGER-BASED REVIEWS

- When you've consistently turned away or rescheduled clients for 30+ days
- When competitor pricing has shifted significantly in either direction
- When your client base has shifted toward higher-value segments
- When inflation has measurably affected your cost structure

2.3 What to evaluate at each review

COST ANALYSIS

- What's the actual cost per job for each tier today?
- How has cost per job changed since the last review?
- Are there cost increases not yet reflected in pricing?
- What's the realistic cost trajectory for the next 6 months?

MARGIN ANALYSIS

- What margin are you actually maintaining at each tier?
- Has margin compressed since the last review?
- Where is margin healthiest vs weakest?
- Are there tiers where margin should be improved?

DEMAND ANALYSIS

- Are you consistently booked or do you have gaps?
- Are clients pushing back on pricing or accepting it readily?
- Is your conversion rate from inquiry to booking healthy?
- Could prices increase without losing client base?

COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

- How does your pricing compare to competitors at similar quality level?
- Are you priced as a premium or as a discount option?
- Is your positioning consistent with the price you charge?

- What pricing changes have competitors made recently?

2.4 How to actually adjust prices

FOR NEW CLIENTS

Simple — apply new pricing immediately to all new bookings. No grandfathering, no announcements needed. New clients only know the current price.

FOR EXISTING CLIENTS

More careful approach. Existing clients have an expectation based on what you've charged. Sudden increases damage trust. Gradual increases preserve relationships.

- Provide 30 days notice before any price increase to existing clients
- Limit increases to 10–15% maximum per review cycle
- Communicate clearly — costs have risen, quality has improved, etc.
- Honor any prior commitments (especially for maintenance plan clients)
- Be willing to lose 1–2 price-sensitive clients to preserve healthy margin

COMMUNICATION TEMPLATE FOR PRICE ADJUSTMENTS

“Hey [name], wanted to give you advance notice that I’ll be adjusting my service pricing starting [date 30 days out]. Your Tier 1 Full Clean will move from \$7,200 to \$7,800 to reflect rising chemical and supply costs. As a maintenance plan client you’ll continue receiving the 10% discount off the new standard rate. Thank you for your continued business — let me know if you have any questions.”

2.5 When NOT to raise prices

DON'T RAISE PRICES WHEN

- Your demand is genuinely soft — you can't fill your existing schedule
- Your quality has slipped or you're behind on commitments
- Recent client feedback suggests value perception has decreased
- Major economic disruption is affecting your market broadly
- Within 6 months of the previous price increase

THE DISCIPLINE TRAP

*The most common pricing mistake isn't **overcharging** — it's undercharging out of fear. Founders worried about losing clients keep prices artificially low for years, training their market to expect cheap pricing. Over time this becomes self-fulfilling — they actually can't **raise prices because they've** established themselves as the cheap option. Set prices that reflect value from the beginning.*

Section 03

The Complaint Handling Protocol

Specific scripts for handling complaints without damaging relationships or your busi-

ness.

3.1 The principle that should guide all complaint handling

How you handle complaints matters more than the complaints themselves. A client who has a problem and watches you handle it well becomes a stronger advocate than a client who never had a problem at all. A client who has a problem and watches you handle it poorly becomes a stronger detractor than the worst review.

THE ASYMMETRY

Most clients won't tell you when they're satisfied — they just keep booking. But when something goes wrong, they tell their friends. The way you handle complaints shapes word-of-mouth far more than the way you handle perfect jobs.

3.2 The five categories of complaint

QUALITY COMPLAINT

Client believes the work wasn't done properly. Missed spots, swirl marks, residue left behind, interior not deep enough.

DAMAGE COMPLAINT

Client believes you damaged something during the service. Scratches, broken trim, missing items, stains.

SERVICE DELIVERY COMPLAINT

Client unhappy with how the service itself was delivered. Late arrival, communication issues, behavior at the site.

PRICING COMPLAINT

Client unhappy with what they were charged versus what they expected. Misunderstanding of inclusions, surprise add-on charges.

OUTCOME EXPECTATION COMPLAINT

Client wanted the service to do something it can't do. Wanted scratches removed by a basic wash, expected showroom finish from Tier 0 service.

3.3 The general response framework

Regardless of complaint type, the initial response follows the same pattern:

- Listen completely without interrupting or defending
- Acknowledge what they're feeling — not necessarily what they're saying
- Ask specific questions to understand the concern
- Take responsibility for resolving it, even if the cause isn't entirely on you
- Propose a specific resolution
- Confirm the resolution actually addresses their concern
- Follow through immediately and visibly

3.4 Specific scripts by complaint type

QUALITY COMPLAINT SCRIPT

"I really appreciate you letting me know — I want every job done right. Can you walk me through specifically what you're seeing? I'd like to come back at no charge and address it properly. When works for you in the next day or two?"

Key elements: gratitude for the feedback, specific information request, immediate offer to fix at no cost, urgency in scheduling. Do not get defensive about the work. Do not blame the client for not pointing it out at completion.

DAMAGE COMPLAINT SCRIPT

"I'm sorry to hear that — let's figure out what happened. Can you send me a photo so I can see exactly what you're seeing? I'll want to look at my before-and-after photos from the service to compare. I want to make this right however I can."

Key elements: empathy without immediate admission of fault, request for visual evidence, reference to your documentation, commitment to resolution. The before/after photos protect both of you — they show what was there before service and what was there after.

SERVICE DELIVERY COMPLAINT SCRIPT

"You're right to mention this. I should have communicated better about [specific issue]. I'm going to take this seriously — what would feel like an appropriate response from me? Whether that's a discount on this service, a free add-on next time, or just an apology and a commitment to do better."

Key elements: ownership of the issue, asking what would make it right, offering specific options for resolution. The client feels heard and gets to choose what works for them.

PRICING COMPLAINT SCRIPT

"Let me make sure I understand — you're saying [their concern]. Looking back at our conversation/agreement, here's what was discussed [reference written record]. I can see how this caused confusion. Here's what I can do to make it right [specific offer]."

Key elements: confirming you understand the issue, referencing written record, acknowledging confusion without conceding error, offering a specific resolution. This is why having a service contract matters — written records prevent these disputes.

OUTCOME EXPECTATION COMPLAINT SCRIPT

"I hear you, and I want to make sure we got this right. The service you booked was [Tier 0/1/2/3] which includes [specific items]. What you're describing wanting would actually be addressed by [higher tier service]. I'd be happy to do that for you at [adjusted price] if you'd like to upgrade, or I can refund the difference if you feel the wrong service was recommended."

Key elements: validating their expectation, clarifying what was actually delivered vs what they wanted, offering a path forward. This complaint type usually resolves

through education, not refund.

3.5 When to absorb the cost vs when not to

ALWAYS ABSORB THE COST WHEN

- Quality genuinely fell short of your standard
- You damaged something during the service
- You arrived late or cancelled with insufficient notice
- You miscommunicated pricing or inclusions
- The complaint will affect your reputation if not resolved

DON'T ABSORB THE COST WHEN

- The client is asking for results outside the booked tier (offer upgrade instead)
- The damage was clearly pre-existing (your before photos prove this)
- The client is being abusive or unreasonable
- The client has a pattern of complaints across multiple services
- Absorbing would set a precedent you can't sustain

3.6 When to fire a client

Some clients aren't worth keeping. Specifically:

- Clients who repeatedly complain about quality without specific evidence
- Clients who are abusive to you personally
- Clients who pay late or dispute charges regularly
- Clients who damage your reputation through public criticism
- Clients whose maintenance plan compliance is consistently poor

Firing a client respectfully:

"I appreciate the business we've done together, but I don't think I'm the right detailer for what you're looking for. I'd recommend finding someone whose service fits your expectations better. Best of luck."

THE PROTECTION YOUR CONTRACT PROVIDES

The service contract document we created earlier specifically addresses pre-existing damage, limits of liability, and your right to refuse service. When complaints arise, that contract is your protection. Use it. The 24-hour reporting window also protects you from disputes raised weeks later about issues that may not have been caused by your service.

Section 04

Bookkeeping & Tax Preparation****

What to track, when to file, what to keep — staying compliant without creating a paperwork burden.

4.1 Why this matters from day one

Most small business operators start tracking finances seriously only when they have to — usually when tax time arrives or a loan application requires records. By then, months of data are missing or incomplete. Starting clean from day one prevents this entirely.

Good financial records serve multiple purposes:

- Accurate tax filing without panic
- Clear visibility into actual profit and loss
- Loan applications backed by demonstrable revenue
- Insurance applications with supporting documentation
- Sale of the business eventually with verifiable financials

4.2 The simple bookkeeping system

WHAT YOU NEED

A spreadsheet (Google Sheets recommended for cloud backup). Two main tabs minimum — Income and Expenses. Optional third tab for Mileage if you want to track vehicle costs separately.

INCOME TRACKING COLUMNS

- Date of service
- Client name
- Vehicle/service description
- Service tier
- Amount charged
- Payment method (cash, transfer, mobile)
- Payment received date
- Notes

EXPENSE TRACKING COLUMNS

- Date of expense
- Category (chemicals, fuel, equipment, etc.)
- Vendor or where purchased
- Description
- Amount
- Payment method
- Receipt available (yes/no)
- Notes

4.3 What you must keep as documentation

ALWAYS KEEP

- Receipts for all chemical and supply purchases
- Fuel receipts when used for business travel
- Equipment purchase receipts and warranties
- Insurance policy documents
- Vehicle registration and fitness certificates
- Your service agreement documents (signed by clients)
- Bank statements for the business account
- Any business license documents

OPTIONAL BUT VALUABLE

- Photos of receipts before they fade
- Invoices to clients (when you start providing them)
- Email confirmations of bookings
- WhatsApp screenshots of significant client communications

4.4 The Jamaican tax filing reality

AS A SOLE TRADER OPERATING INFORMALLY

Your detailing income flows through your personal Income Tax filing. As a sole trader, business income is treated as personal income for tax purposes.

WHAT YOU NEED TO FILE

- Personal Income Tax filing annually (typically by March 15th for previous year)
- Income Tax Form S04 if applicable
- Schedule of business income and expenses
- Documentation supporting major deductions

WORKING WITH A TAX PROFESSIONAL

For your situation, a tax professional consultation in Year 1 is worth the investment. Estimated cost: \$15,000-\$30,000 JMD for proper filing assistance. They'll help you:

- Identify all legitimate business expense deductions
- Structure your filing correctly
- Plan for the next year's tax obligations
- Navigate any GCT or business registration questions

4.5 What's deductible as a sole trader detailer

DIRECT BUSINESS EXPENSES

- All chemicals, supplies, and consumables
- Equipment purchases
- Vehicle expenses for business use (proportional if shared)
- Insurance for business activities
- Communication costs for business phone/data
- Business-related travel
- Marketing and advertising

SOMETIMES DEDUCTIBLE

- Portion of home utilities if you store equipment at home
- Training and education in your craft
- Professional services (accountant, legal advice)
- Bank fees for business account

GENERALLY NOT DEDUCTIBLE

- Personal vehicle use for non-business activities
- Personal phone use
- Clothing unless specifically branded uniform
- Meals unless specifically for client meetings

4.6 The annual review checklist

Each January or February, before tax preparation:

- Reconcile all income for the previous year
- Reconcile all expenses for the previous year
- Calculate net income
- Gather all supporting documentation
- Identify any missing receipts and document approximate amounts
- Schedule appointment with tax professional if using one
- File before the deadline
- Save all filed documents in cloud storage

THE HIDDEN COST OF POOR RECORDS

*Operators who don't track properly often pay more tax than they should — they **can't** substantiate deductions they're entitled to. They also can't access financing or insurance products that require demonstrable history. The discipline of tracking from day one is one of the highest-ROI activities in your business.*

Section 05

Customer Database Strategy

What information becomes valuable over time — and how to capture it from day one.

5.1 Why your client database is your most valuable asset

In service businesses, the client list isn't just a contact list — it's the foundation of recurring revenue, referrals, and resilience. A well-maintained client database with rich information becomes more valuable every year. A poorly maintained one is just a list of phone numbers.

5.2 What to capture per client

BASIC INFORMATION

- Full name
- Primary phone number / WhatsApp
- Secondary contact if available
- Email address (for future formal communications)
- Service address(es) — home, work, other locations
- How they found you (referral source)

VEHICLE INFORMATION

- Make, model, year, color
- License plate
- Any specific notes — paint type, modifications, sensitive areas
- Multiple vehicles if applicable

SERVICE HISTORY

- Date of every service completed
- Service tier delivered
- Amount paid
- Payment method used
- Any add-ons or special services included
- Notes about the job — specific concerns, special requests

PREFERENCES AND PATTERNS

- Preferred day of week / time of day for service
- Communication preferences (call, text, WhatsApp)
- Whether they prefer you to call before arriving
- Specific products they like or don't like
- Family members who also use your services

RELATIONSHIP NOTES

- Personal details they've shared (children's names, work, interests)
- Special occasions you should remember (birthdays, anniversaries)
- Referrals they've sent you
- Any complaints and how they were resolved
- Whether they're on a maintenance plan

5.3 Why each category matters

BASIC INFORMATION

Foundation for any communication. The address allows geographic clustering when scheduling. The referral source tells you which marketing channels actually produce clients.

VEHICLE INFORMATION

Allows you to recommend services appropriately. A 10-year-old vehicle with paint oxidation needs different service than a new vehicle. Multi-vehicle clients become high-value when you serve all their cars.

SERVICE HISTORY

Lifetime client value calculation. Identifies your highest-value clients. Reveals patterns — clients who book Tier 1 then upgrade to Tier 2 over time. Tells you when to suggest specific add-ons based on what's been done previously.

PREFERENCES AND PATTERNS

Demonstrates you remember them. A client whose preferred Saturday morning slot is honored without them having to remind you feels valued in a way one-time clients don't.

RELATIONSHIP NOTES

This is what separates transactional businesses from relationship businesses. Remembering a client's daughter's name, asking about a job they mentioned, acknowledging an anniversary — these touches transform clients into advocates.

5.4 How to actually maintain this

UPDATE AT THREE TRIGGER POINTS

- After every job — service history and any new notes
- After any significant conversation — relationship notes
- Quarterly review — clean up, identify patterns, flag lapsed clients

THE 5-MINUTE DISCIPLINE

After every job, before you leave the site or immediately after, spend 5 minutes updating the client record. This is non-negotiable. Information you don't capture immediately is rarely captured later.

QUARTERLY DATABASE REVIEW

Once per quarter, review your full client database and answer:

- Who hasn't booked in 90+ days? (Reactivation outreach)
- Who is approaching maintenance plan due dates? (Reminder outreach)
- Who has highest lifetime value? (Premium relationship cultivation)
- Who has referred others? (Acknowledgment and gratitude)
- Who is most at risk of leaving? (Retention efforts)

5.5 Privacy and data discipline

Client data deserves respect:

- Don't share client information with anyone outside the business
- Backup your database to cloud storage
- If you eventually have employees, limit access to need-to-know
- Don't use client data for purposes beyond service and direct communication
- Delete data of clients who explicitly request it

THE COMPOUNDING EFFECT

*Year 1 your database is small and basic. Year 3 it's a **substantial competitive advantage**. Year 5 it's the most valuable asset in your business — knowing who your clients are, what they need, when they need it, and how to keep serving them. Build it deliberately from day one.*

Section 06

Seasonal Patterns in Jamaica

How the year flows for detailing demand — and what to do during slow seasons.

6.1 The Jamaican year in detailing terms

Detailing demand isn't constant. It rises and falls with weather, holidays, economic cycles, and events. Understanding these patterns lets you plan capacity, marketing, and cash flow appropriately rather than being surprised by predictable cycles.

6.2 Month-by-month demand patterns

MONTH	DEMAND	WHY
January	Strong	New year, fresh starts, post-holiday cleanup
February	Moderate	Carnival prep begins, valentine vehicles
March	Moderate	Pre-Easter cleaning, normal demand
April	Strong	Easter holiday vehicles, family events
May	Moderate	Mother's Day prep, regular demand
June	Soft	Hurricane season starts, weather uncertainty
July	Soft	Summer rains, vacation season
August	Moderate	Independence Day, family events
September	Soft	Peak hurricane season, back-to-school spending
October	Moderate	Heroes weekend, demand recovery

MONTH	DEMAND	WHY
November	Strong	Pre-Christmas vehicle preparation begins
December	Very Strong	Christmas, Boxing Day, holiday vehicles

6.3 How to use seasonal patterns strategically

DURING STRONG MONTHS

Push pricing slightly higher. Demand exceeds supply, you can sustain top-of-range pricing. Focus on Tier 2 and Tier 3 services where premium clients are willing to pay for special-occasion preparation. Build cash reserves aggressively to fund slower months.

DURING MODERATE MONTHS

Run your standard pricing and operating rhythm. Focus on consistent execution and client retention. Use the time for skill development, system refinement, and marketing investment that pays off in subsequent strong months.

DURING SOFT MONTHS

This is when most operators panic and discount. Don't. Instead:

- Aggressively promote maintenance plan enrollment to lock in recurring revenue
- Run targeted promotions on weekday slots to fill gaps without devaluing weekends
- Use slow time for major equipment maintenance and improvements
- Invest in marketing that pays off in upcoming strong months
- Train new techniques you'll deploy when demand returns

6.4 Hurricane season specifics

June through November requires specific planning beyond just demand patterns:

OPERATIONAL CONSIDERATIONS

- Active hurricane warnings should pause all outdoor work immediately
- Equipment must be secured against potential storm damage
- Vehicle access to clients may be temporarily impossible
- Schedule flexibility becomes critical — clients reschedule frequently

BUSINESS CONTINUITY PLANNING

- Maintain higher cash reserves June through November
- Don't take on major financial commitments during peak hurricane months
- Have indoor storage option for equipment and chemicals
- Communicate proactively with clients about weather-related rescheduling

6.5 Special events and opportunities

PRE-HOLIDAY BOOKING SURGES

Three specific surge periods worth planning around:

- Pre-Easter — typically 2 weeks before
- Pre-Independence Day weekend — late July, early August
- Pre-Christmas — entire month of December

During these surges, your calendar fills weeks in advance. Communicate availability early. Consider taking deposits to secure bookings. Don't take on more than you can deliver — quality during surge periods builds reputation, while burnout damages it.

SPECIAL OCCASIONS THAT DRIVE BOOKINGS

- Wedding car preparation — premium service opportunity
- Pre-sale vehicle preparation — when clients are selling their cars
- Post-purchase detailing — new car or used car cleanup
- Photo shoots and video productions — vehicle prep for content
- Dealership prep — if you eventually serve commercial clients

THE ANNUAL RHYTHM

Year 1 you're learning the rhythm. Year 2 you're planning around it. Year 3 you're profiting from it. The detailers who understand seasonal patterns build resilient businesses. The ones who don't get whipsawed by demand they could have anticipated.

Section 07

Competitor Analysis Framework

How to assess competitors and position effectively without losing focus on your own business.

7.1 Why structured competitor analysis matters

Most service business operators either ignore competitors entirely or obsess over them constantly. Both extremes hurt the business. Ignoring competitors means missing real shifts in your market. Obsessing means you stop focusing on your own work and start chasing what others are doing.

The right approach is structured analysis on a deliberate schedule — quarterly review of your competitive landscape, applying lessons to your own business, then refocusing on execution.

7.2 Identify your actual competitors

DIRECT COMPETITORS

Other mobile detailers operating in Kingston and St. Andrew at similar service tiers. These are the operations clients are most likely to compare you against directly. Focus most of your analysis here.

INDIRECT COMPETITORS

- Fixed-location car washes and detailing shops
- Auto dealership detailing services
- Independent contractors who detail occasionally
- Mechanics or auto shops that offer cleaning add-ons

SUBSTITUTION THREATS

- Self-service car washes
- DIY detailing as a hobby
- Friends or family doing it for free
- Doing nothing — accepting a dirty vehicle

7.3 What to learn about each direct competitor

IDENTIFICATION BASICS

- Business name and primary contact
- Geographic operating area
- How long they've been operating
- Apparent size — solo, small team, larger operation

SERVICE OFFERING

- What tiers of service they offer
- Their stated pricing for each tier
- What's included in each tier
- Add-on services available
- Maintenance or recurring service offers

MARKETING PRESENCE

- Social media accounts they maintain
- Posting frequency and content quality
- Follower count and engagement levels
- Reviews and testimonials visible
- How they describe themselves

OPERATIONAL SIGNALS

- Vehicle and equipment they use (visible from posts)
- Apparent quality of work in their before/after content
- Response time to inquiries (if testable)
- Professional indicators — uniform, branded vehicle, etc.

7.4 How to actually do the research

PUBLIC SOURCE REVIEW

- Search ‘mobile detailing Jamaica’ and similar terms
- Browse Instagram hashtags relevant to your area
- Check Google Business listings in your operating area
- Review Facebook business pages and groups
- Note any visible advertising — vehicle wraps, signage

CONVERSATIONAL INTELLIGENCE

- When clients mention competitors, listen carefully without dismissing
- Ask new clients about their previous detailing experiences
- Note specific complaints clients have about other services
- Learn what brought them to you specifically

WHAT NOT TO DO

- Don’t engage in negative comparisons publicly
- Don’t fabricate inquiries to spy on competitors
- Don’t poach competitor employees explicitly
- Don’t copy their content or branding

7.5 How to use what you learn

PRICING BENCHMARKING

Where does your pricing fall relative to direct competitors? If you’re significantly below the median, you might be undercharging. If significantly above, your value proposition needs to be very clear to justify the gap.

SERVICE GAP IDENTIFICATION

What services do competitors offer that you don’t? What services do you offer that they don’t? Gaps in either direction are strategic information. Some competitor offerings might be worth adding. Some of your unique offerings might deserve more marketing emphasis.

MARKETING BENCHMARK

How does your social media presence compare? Are competitors posting more frequently, with better quality, with more engagement? This reveals either where you need to improve or where their strengths lie.

POSITIONING CLARITY

Once you understand the competitive landscape, your positioning becomes clearer. You’re not just ‘a mobile detailer.’ You’re ‘the premium ceramic-focused mobile detailer in Kingston.’ Or ‘the maintenance plan specialist for busy professionals.’ Or

whatever genuinely fits your offering and competitive context.

7.6 The quarterly competitor review

Once per quarter, spend 1-2 hours on structured competitor analysis:

- Update your awareness of who's operating in your space
- Note any new entrants or operations that have closed
- Review pricing changes among existing competitors
- Assess what's working in their marketing
- Identify any specific learnings to apply to your operation

THE COMPETITIVE PRINCIPLE

You can't out-compete others by becoming a slightly better version of them. You out-compete by being clearly distinct in ways that matter to clients. Use competitor analysis to clarify what makes you different, not to copy what makes them similar.

Section 08

Service Procedures by Tier

The documented step-by-step for each tier of service.

8.1 Why documented procedures matter

Right now you execute services from memory and habit. That works while you're solo. The moment you have an employee, hire help, or even just have a busy week — undocumented procedures lead to inconsistency. Different jobs get done differently. Quality becomes unpredictable. Clients notice.

Documented procedures serve three purposes:

- Consistency across every job, every time
- Training foundation when you eventually hire
- Quality control standards for ongoing operation

8.2 Tier 0 — Quick Wash Procedure

TIME ALLOCATION: 30-40 MINUTES

EQUIPMENT REQUIRED

- Pressure washer (Emtop preferred for water efficiency)
- Two-bucket setup with grit guards
- Wash mitt
- Drying microfibers (2 minimum)
- Glass cleaner and microfiber
- Tyre foam
- Optional: Quick detailer spray

STEP-BY-STEP PROCEDURE

- 1. Walk-around inspection — note any pre-existing damage, communicate with client
- 2. Pre-rinse from top to bottom
- 3. Apply soap using foam cannon or two-bucket method
- 4. Wash one panel at a time, rinsing mitt in clean water bucket between strokes
- 5. Rinse soap off thoroughly, top to bottom
- 6. Dry immediately with microfiber, panel by panel
- 7. Clean exterior windows and mirrors
- 8. Apply tyre foam to all four tyres
- 9. Final walk-around with client
- 10. Take 8 standard angle photos
- 11. Collect payment and update tracker

QUALITY CHECKPOINT

Before declaring complete: paint surface dry without water spots, glass clear, tyres dressed, no soap residue, no missed spots.

8.3 Tier 1 — Full Clean Procedure

TIME ALLOCATION: 75-90 MINUTES

EQUIPMENT REQUIRED

All Tier 0 equipment plus:

- Vacuum cleaner
- APC and dilution sprayer
- Interior cleaning microfibers (separated from exterior)
- Plastic restorer
- Glass cleaner for interior windows
- Wheel cleaner and brushes

STEP-BY-STEP PROCEDURE

- 1. Walk-around inspection and pre-existing damage documentation
- 2. Vacuum interior thoroughly while exterior pre-rinse dwells
- 3. Pre-rinse exterior top to bottom
- 4. Apply prewash soap and let dwell
- 5. Clean wheels and tyres while soap dwells
- 6. Two-bucket wash of exterior, panel by panel

- 7. Rinse exterior thoroughly
- 8. Dry exterior immediately, panel by panel
- 9. APC interior surfaces — dashboard, console, door panels, vents
- 10. Wipe down all interior hard surfaces
- 11. Clean interior glass
- 12. Clean exterior glass and mirrors
- 13. Apply plastic restorer to exterior trim
- 14. Apply tyre dressing (gel or quality dressing, not just foam)
- 15. Clean door jambs
- 16. Final walk-around with client
- 17. Take 8 standard angle photos plus interior detail shot
- 18. Collect payment and update tracker
- 19. Send next-day follow-up message

8.4 Tier 2 — Deep Clean Procedure

TIME ALLOCATION: 3-4 HOURS

EQUIPMENT REQUIRED

All Tier 1 equipment plus:

- Seat shampoo or fabric extraction equipment
- Carpet cleaning solution
- Stain treatment products
- Leather cleaner and conditioner
- Cerakote interior detailer
- Detail brushes for vents, crevices, and tight areas

STEP-BY-STEP PROCEDURE

- 1-8. Execute Tier 1 exterior procedure completely
- 9. Remove all interior items, mats, and removable elements
- 10. Detailed vacuum of all surfaces, crevices, and underneath items
- 11. Identify stains and apply appropriate treatments
- 12. Shampoo seats and fabric upholstery
- 13. Deep clean carpets with extraction
- 14. Clean leather seats with appropriate products
- 15. Apply leather conditioner where applicable

- 16. Detail clean dashboard, console, and all hard surfaces
- 17. Apply Cerakote interior detailer to all hard surfaces
- 18. Clean vents, crevices, and tight areas with detail brushes
- 19. Clean mats separately and replace
- 20. Final interior glass cleaning
- 21. Final walk-around with client showing transformation
- 22. Comprehensive photo documentation
- 23. Collect payment and update tracker
- 24. Send next-day follow-up with maintenance plan offer

8.5 Tier 3 — Showroom Detail Procedure

TIME ALLOCATION: 5-6 HOURS

EQUIPMENT REQUIRED

All Tier 2 equipment plus:

- Clay bar or clay mitt
- Iron fallout remover
- Polish and DA polisher when available
- Cerakote ceramic sealant
- Engine bay cleaning supplies
- Headlight restoration kit if needed

STEP-BY-STEP PROCEDURE

- 1-17. Execute Tier 2 procedure completely
- 18. Iron fallout treatment on paint and wheels
- 19. Clay bar treatment on entire exterior, panel by panel
- 20. Final wash to remove clay residue
- 21. Polish and paint correction (when DA available)
- 22. Apply Cerakote ceramic sealant in proper conditions
- 23. Allow appropriate cure time
- 24. Buff to final finish
- 25. Engine bay cleaning if booked
- 26. Headlight restoration if booked
- 27. Apply quality tyre dressing (gel)
- 28. Final inspection with client

- 29. Comprehensive photo documentation including reflection shots and water beading
- 30. Provide written ceramic warranty card
- 31. Collect payment and update tracker
- 32. Schedule first follow-up at 4-week mark

CUSTOMIZE OVER TIME

These procedures are starting points based on what we've discussed. As you execute jobs, refine the procedures to match what actually works best with your specific equipment, products, and clients. Update the documentation. The procedures are tools to serve your business — not rules to constrain it.

8.6 How to use these procedures

Three specific applications:

SELF-DISCIPLINE

Reference these procedures yourself. Especially during busy periods when you might rush, follow the steps. Consistency is what builds reputation.

TRAINING

When you eventually hire your first employee, these procedures become the training foundation. Print them. Walk through each step with the new hire. Have them shadow you executing each procedure before they execute solo.

QUALITY CONTROL

When evaluating your own work or eventually employee work, the procedures become the standard. 'Did the procedure get followed?' is more useful than 'does the result look okay?' because procedures produce consistent results while subjective evaluation drifts.

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The reference is complete.

The execution is yours.